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Experience

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol), Professor of Cyber Security

Bristol, UK

Jan 2022 – present
4 years 4 months

- Full Professor in Cyber Security in recognition of 'Advancing Teaching and Learning' (primary domain) and for 'Research with Impact' (secondary domain).
- Successful research grant income with over £2.1M directed awarded from external funding sources, and over £3.7M in total (see projects page for further details).
- Published 90+ academic articles as of April 2026, in high-quality journals and conference venues (see publications page for further details).
- Supervision of PhD student research (4 completions, 6 current
- March 2026), as well as supporting post-doctoral research fellows (2 former, 2 current
- March 2026) (see projects page for further details).
- Experience of supervising 100+ student research projects across undergraduate and postgraduate level, as well as supporting extra curricula paid student research and consultancy work (see projects page for further details).
- Leading outreach initiatives and upskilling educators and industry professionals in cyber security (see teaching page for further details).

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol), Co-Director of UWEcyber Academic Centre of Excellence in Cyber Security Education (NCSC Certified)

Bristol, UK

Oct 2020 – present
5 years 8 months

- Co-Director of UWEcyber 'Gold' NCSC Academic Centre of Excellence in Cyber Security Education (ACE-CSE) that brings together our teaching and learning, external engagement, outreach, research and knowledge exchange in Cyber Security, with a multi-disciplinary perspective involving staff across the entire University, a regional network of educators with a passion to upskill cyber security education, and a regular guest speaker seminar series that has attracted presenters from across the globe.

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol), Programme Leadership Team - BSc Cyber Security and Digital Forensics

Bristol, UK

July 2024 – present
1 year 11 months

- I joined the BSc Cyber Security and Digital Forensics programme leadership team in 2024, to support and mentor a new leadership team, and to further promote opportunities of external industry engagement for our undergraduate students, including the continued organisation of guest speakers as well as new industry collaboration with teaching.

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol), CSRC Cyber Security Research Theme Lead

Bristol, UK

Aug 2019 – present
6 years 10 months

- The Computer Science Research Centre (CSRC) at UWE is made up of 5 themes: Artificial Intelligence, Cyber Security, Data Science, Expressive Computer Interaction, and Smart Cities. I serve as Cyber Security Research Theme Lead since the reorganisation of the CSRC in 2019, supporting academic staff and PhD researchers to develop cyber security research across infrastructure security, software security, AI/data security, and cyber crime domains.

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol), Programme Leader - MSc Cyber Security (NCSC Certified)

Bristol, UK

Jan 2018 – July 2024
6 years 8 months

- Former Programme Leader of the NCSC-Certified MSc Cyber Security, having grown the programme from its initial delivery for 13 students in 2018 to as many as 150 students across two intakes in an academic year, and achieving a PTES overall student satisfaction score of 92% (2024).

University of the West of England (UWE Bristol) , Associate Professor of Cyber Security	Bristol, UK Sept 2018 – Jan 2022 3 years 4 months
University of the West of England (UWE Bristol) , Senior Lecturer in Computer Science	Bristol, UK Feb 2015 – Sept 2018 3 years 8 months
Cabinet Office , Member of the UK Government Cyber Advisory Board (GCAB)	London, UK Mar 2025 – present 1 year 2 months
CSE Connect , Co-Founder / Co-Director A National Cyber Security Education network to bring together academia, industry and government. Supported by the UK National Cyber Security Centre, the network hosts regular events as well as an annual conference, that promotes collaboration and sharing to enhance cyber security education, both within the UK and working with global partners. (Formerly CISSEUK, a UK chapter of CISSE, the Colloquium of Information Systems Security Education)	UK July 2019 – present 6 years 11 months
University of Oxford , Post-Doctoral Research Associate - Cyber Security Centre, Department of Computer Science - Research project: ‘Corporate Insider Threat Detection (CITD)’ funded by the Centre for the Protection of National Infrastructure (CPNI). - Lectureship post at St. Catherine College, teaching Computer Graphics. - Lectureship post at Worcester College, tutoring International students in Computer Graphics - Teaching at the Department of Computer Science includes classes for the Visual Analytics postgraduate course, and both tutorials and practical labs for the Computer Graphics course. - Supervision of postgraduate projects in the Centre for Doctoral Training in Cyber Security	Oxford, UK Mar 2013 – Feb 2015 1 year 11 months
Swansea University , Post-Doctoral Research Assistant - Department of Computer Science - Research project: ‘Sports Video Visualization’ funded by the Welsh Assembly Government. - Guest lecturer on iOS Software Development and Sports Video Visualisation ‘Inspirational Speaker’ and iOS Schools Workshop Lead for Technocamps Wales. - Supervision of undergraduate and postgraduate projects.	Swansea, UK July 2010 – Mar 2013 2 years 9 months
Freelance , Software Developer - Desktop and Mobile (iOS, Android, Blackberry) development. - Over 40,000 paid downloads on the iOS App Store worldwide since July 2011, with Tide Times being recognised in the Stuff magazine ‘200 best apps of all time’, and also achieving #1 in the ‘Top Paid Weather’ category (Summer 2011). - PocketCoder used by top sports clubs worldwide including Manchester United FC, Welsh Rugby Union, Ireland RFU, Barnsley FC, Bolton FC, QPR, and the Football Association. - Desktop software includes collaborative development with University Hospital Wales and NHS, producing a 3D stereoscopic imaging system for ophthalmic clinical assessment based on PhD research. - Proficient in variety of development languages: Python, Javascript, Java, C++, C#, Objective-C, Swift.	UK May 2010 – Feb 2015 4 years 10 months
Cardiff University , Software Developer Development of research-led Android mobile application, GeoCaption.	UK Apr 2010 – July 2010 4 months

Education

	University of the West of England (UWE Bristol) , Postgraduate Certificate in Teaching and Learning for Higher Education	Bristol, UK 2015 – 2016
PhD	Cardiff University, UK , Computer Science Multi-modal Retinal Imaging: Improving Accuracy and Efficiency of Image Registration using Mutual Information	Cardiff, UK 2006 – 2010
BSc	Cardiff University, UK , Computer Science Online Multi-player Chinese Checkers Game with Intelligent Computer Opponent	Cardiff, UK 2003 – 2006

Publications

Adversarially Resilient Federated Learning for Heterogeneous Edge Nodes in 5G Networks with Non-IID Data Saniya Zafar, Phil Legg, Jonathan White, Ahmad Salman 10.1016/j.iot.2026.101919 (Internet of Things)	Mar 2026
LOTL-hunter: Detecting multi-stage living-off-the-land attacks in cyber-physical systems using decision fusion techniques with digital twins Carol Lo, Thu Yein Win, Zeinab Rezaeifar, Zaheer Khan, Phil Legg 10.1016/j.future.2026.108382 (Future Generation Computer Systems)	Mar 2026
Advances in Teaching and Learning for Cyber Security Education Phil Legg, Natalie Coull, Charles Clarke 10.1007/978-3-032-15105-6 (Springer)	Jan 2026
Machine Learning and Data Analytics for Cyber Security Phil Legg, Giorgio Giacinto 10.3390/books978-3-7258-3360-3 (MDPI)	Apr 2025

Certificates

CompTIA SecurityX CAS-005	July 2024
Chartered Institute of Information Security (CIISec) Full Member	Oct 2022
CompTIA PenTest+ PT0-002	May 2021
Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals SC-900	Apr 2021
Azure Data Fundamentals DP-900	Mar 2021
Azure AI Fundamentals AI-900	Feb 2021
Azure Fundamentals AZ-900	Oct 2020
CompTIA Security+ SY0-501	July 2020

Projects

UWEcyber Research Laboratory strategic investment Wallscourt Foundation (£1.5m).	Oct 2023 – Oct 2027
Cyber Sandpit - Linking cyber effect to mission objectives DSTL Serapis Framework in collaboration with Trimetis Ltd. (Total £120k, UWE £50k).	Jan 2023 – Oct 2023

Every human a sensor - Crowdsourcing Cyber Data DSTL Serapis Framework in collaboration with Trimetis Ltd. (Total £80k, UWE £41k).	Jan 2023 – Oct 2023
Teaching CyBOK through Cyber Physical Systems CyBOK (Cyber Security Body of Knowledge) and NCSC (Total £5k).	Jan 2023 – June 2023
Autonomous Resilience in Cyber Defence DSTL Serapis Framework in collaboration with Trimetis Ltd. (Total £30k, UWE £5k).	Sept 2022 – Nov 2022
Cyber Security and Data Governance for SMEs National Cyber Security Centre (Total £40k).	Sept 2022 – Mar 2023
CyberWEST - Cyber Security Education for Schools National Cyber Security Centre (Total £41k).	Sept 2022 – Mar 2023
Transform Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs) - UK First Technology Line of Defence InnovateUK Smart Grant in collaboration with Synalogik Ltd. (Total £458k, UWE £37k).	Sept 2022 – Feb 2024
Building a place-based approach to preventing online sexual abuse Vice Chancellor's Challenge Fund 2022-23 (Total £25k internal).	May 2022 – Apr 2023
Turing Network Development Awards Alan Turing Institute (Total £25k).	Feb 2022 – Jan 2023
Cyber Security and Cyber Crime Cluster (CSC3) UWE Expanding Research Excellence Scheme (Total £100k internal).	Feb 2022 – July 2023
Cyber security analytics in telecommunications systems: Managing security and service in complex real-time 5G networks PhD 50-50 studentship in collaboration with Ribbon Communications Ltd. (Total £35k external, £35k internal).	Jan 2022 – Dec 2024
Co-creation of innovative school projects for teachers to improve cyber security education National Cyber Security Centre (Total £50k).	Sept 2021 – Feb 2022
Teaching CyBOK Cyber-Physical Systems Security through Interactive Simulation CyBOK / National Cyber Security Centre (Total £5k).	Jan 2021 – Apr 2021
Identifying and Tackling Counter-Terrorism Finances through Investigation Automation (SCOUT: A fully automated enhanced risk assessment engine) InnovateUK Smart Grants (Total £490k).	Apr 2020 – Mar 2022
Cyber Security Assessment for Project CAVForth (An Autonomous Bus Service From Park & Ride Across Forth Bridge to Edinburgh Park Train & Tram Interchange) Innovate UK and Centre for Connected and Autonomous Vehicles (CCAV) (Total £34k).	Jan 2020 – Dec 2020
Analysis and Visualisation of Ransomware and Malicious Network Propagation National Cyber Security Centre Internship Award (Total £2.4k).	May 2019 – Sept 2019
Penetration testing Consultancy VQ Communications Ltd. (Total £9k).	Nov 2019 – July 2020

Interactive Inspection of Adversarial Machine Learning for Collaborative Human-Machine Trust and Security in Data-Driven Military and Defence PhD 50-50 studentship in collaboration with Techmodal Ltd. (Total £35k external, £35k internal).	Oct 2019 – Sept 2022
Shared Collaborative Project Planning in Secure Federated Learning Environments PhD 50-50 studentship in collaboration with Techmodal Ltd. (Total £35k external, £35k internal).	Oct 2019 – Sept 2022
Travel Grant: Colloquium for Information Systems Security in Education 2019, Las Vegas, USA National Cyber Security Centre (Total £2k).	July 2019 – July 2019
Cyber Security in the Home: Detecting IoT Threats National Cyber Security Centre Internship Award (Total £2.4k).	May 2019 – Sept 2019
Travel Grant: Colloquium for Information Systems Security in Education 2018, New Orleans, USA National Cyber Security Centre (Total £2k).	July 2018 – July 2018
HASTE: Human-centric Active-learning for decision Support in Threat Exploration DSTL Defence and Security Accelerator (Total £85k).	Feb 2018 – July 2018
Creating Machine Intelligence with Intelligent Interactive Visualisation PhD 50-50 studentship in collaboration with Montvieux Ltd. (Total £35k external, £35k internal).	Oct 2016 – Sept 2019
RicherPicture: Automated network defence through business and threat-led machine learning – Phase 2 DSTL Centre for Defence Enterprise (Total £280k).	Apr 2016 – Mar 2017
Enhanced personal situational awareness through network and systems visualization UWE Bristol Vice-Chancellor's Early Career Researcher Development Awards (Total £13k internal).	Aug 2015 – July 2016
RicherPicture: Automated network defence through business and threat-led machine learning DSTL Centre for Defence Enterprise (Total £108k).	Apr 2015 – Sept 2016

Awards

Best Paper Award IEEE International Conference on Cyber Situational Awareness, Data Analytics and Assessment (Cyber SA 2016) c-mric.org	July 2016
CSCT Researcher of the Year Award Faculty of Environment and Technology, UWE Bristol www.uwe.ac.uk	July 2015
Best Paper Award Managing Insider Security Threats (MIST) conference isyou.info/conf/mist14	Nov 2014

Invited Talks

Transparency as The Foundation, Standards, Assurance, and Trust in Cyber Security, CYBERUK, 2026

Trowbridge musician's warning after voice and face used in AI deep fake romance scam, ITV News, 2026

Security and AI in the year of vibe coding and computer use agents, where do we go next? Keynote speaker at 10th International Conference on Internet of Things and Connected Technologies (ICIoTCT 2025), Maulana Azad National Institute of Technology (MANIT), Bhopal, India. December 2025.

Cyber Security and Artificial Intelligence, AI for Security or the Security of AI?, Cyber security research seminar series, Centre for Cyber Security, Communications and Network Research, University of Plymouth (2025).

Cyber Security and Artificial Intelligence, AI for Security or the Security of AI?, International Conference on Future Tech, CASUGOL Singapore Keynote Speaker, June 2023.

Cyber Growth and Innovation, Invited Panel Member, DSIT, Engine Shed Bristol, March 2023.

Cynam Guest Host, Cyber Cheltenham, March 2023.

Breaking into Cyber Security, CASUGOL Singapore, October 2022.

Getting into Cyber Security, NCSC CyberFirst Futures, August 2022.

Cryptocurrency, crime, and cyber security, Let's Make Tech Inclusive, London Borough of Redbridge, May 2022.

An audience with Professor Phil Legg, UK Cyber Security Council Leader's Briefing, May 2022.

Cyber Security and the Global Pandemic, City of Bristol College, February 2022.

Cyber Security and Working with Academia, South West Cyber Resilience Centre, December 2021.

HCI and Cyber Security Boundaries and Fusion, Cardiff University, December 2021.

Cyber Security at UWE, UTC Berkeley Green, July 2021.

Post-Pandemic Cyber Security Education, IEEE Cyber Science Keynote Speaker, June 2021.

Light bulbs and race cars, Cyber security education using cyber-physical systems, Cybersecurity, Privacy and Human-Centred Computing Seminar, Cardiff University, March 2021

Cyber Security, AI, and Digital Futures, CASUGOL Nights Out Talk, September 2020.

Colloquium on Information Systems Security Education UK: How do we inspire sharing and collaboration in higher education, NCSC Annual Education Conference, Stratford upon Avon, 2019.

Establishing a forum for the UK cyber security education community, and the role of education with research, NCSC Academic Centres of Excellence in Cyber Security Research (ACECSR) Annual Conference, Stratford upon Avon, 2019.

Cyber Security in the UK, Addressing the state of the nation, Colloquium on Information Systems Security Education, Las Vegas, USA, 2019.

Establishing a forum for the UK cyber security education community, CYBERUK, Glasgow, 2019

What do we really mean by ‘understanding cyber security’?, Emerson Green Library, Bristol Festival of Learning, June 2018.

Visual Analytics and Human Machine Collaboration for Insider Threat Detection, University of Bristol, December 2017.

Human Machine Collaboration in Active Machine Learning, Adarga.ai, August 2017.

Data Driven Decision Making, Cranfield University, April 2016.

Visualizing Cyber Security, vLunch, Cardiff University, March 2016.

Visualization What is it good for? Software Engineering Research Group, UWE, March 2015.

****Corporate Insider Threat Detection, SMi Oil and Gas Cyber Security, Oslo, June 2014. ****

****Corporate Insider Threat Detection, CIFAS Annual conference, London, June 2013. ****

****Glyph-based Visualization for Sports Analytics, Sports Informatics Symposium, Loughborough University, June 2012. ****

****Glyph-based Visualization for Sports Analytics, Glyph-Based Visualization Workshop, Oxford University, May 2012. ****

Sports Video Visualization, vLunch, Cardiff University, October 2011.